

New Construction Buyer Checklist

Indy Property Guide · Powered by Your Realty Link · Daniel Cope, Broker · 317-201-6323

Before You Buy

- ☐ Bring your own agent BEFORE you visit the model — the on-site agent works for the builder
- ☐ Get pre-approved so you know your real budget
- ☐ Research the builder: reviews, recent communities, warranty reputation
- ☐ Understand the base price vs. what upgrades will realistically add

Choosing Your Home

- ☐ Select the lot carefully — premium lots, drainage, orientation, what backs up to it
- ☐ Choose the floor plan for how you actually live
- ☐ Separate must-have upgrades from nice-to-haves before the design center
- ☐ Confirm exactly what's standard vs. an upgrade (flooring, cabinets, fixtures)

The Contract

- ☐ Read the builder's contract carefully — it favors the builder by default
- ☐ Understand the build timeline and any delay clauses
- ☐ Confirm the deposit / earnest money and what's refundable
- ☐ Review the HOA documents and dues before signing
- ☐ Understand the structural and workmanship warranty terms

Financing

- ☐ Compare the builder's lender incentive against an outside quote
- ☐ A closing-cost credit with a worse rate can cost more over time — compare the whole package

During the Build

- ☐ Schedule and attend the pre-drywall walkthrough
- ☐ Photograph everything before drywall goes up (wiring, plumbing, framing)
- ☐ Track the timeline and stay in regular contact with your builder rep

Final Walkthrough

- ☐ Create a punch list of every unfinished or defective item
- ☐ Test everything: outlets, faucets, appliances, HVAC, windows, doors
- ☐ Confirm every upgrade you paid for is installed correctly
- ☐ Get an independent inspection — yes, even on a brand-new home

After Closing

- ☐ Budget for landscaping, window treatments, fencing and appliances
- ☐ Submit warranty items promptly and keep records
- ☐ File the homestead exemption on your new primary residence

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This checklist is general guidance for Indiana buyers and sellers, not legal or tax advice. Questions? Call or text Daniel at 317-201-6323.